# 2024 - Subject Evaluation Report BIOL340 Cell and Molecular Biology Autumn

Project Title: **Autumn 2024 - Subject and Lecturer Evaluations**

Subject Enrolments: **161**
Responses Received: **20**
Response Rate: **12.42%**

## Report Comments

This report combines subject evaluation results for all instances where a subject is taught across multiple campuses or modes in a single session.

The report provides:

- SEBS response rate and basic respondent demographics
- Overall evaluation ratings and ratings for each question
- Comparisons with your school for the current session
- Free-text comments – providing valuable information on aspects important to students and suggestions for improvements.

If you have any questions about this report, contact uow-evaluations@uow.edu.au.

## Interpreting the data

- Subject Instance Reports are generated only when six or more students complete the survey. However, the results for subjects with fewer than six respondents are included in the aggregate reports.
- Response rates of less than 10% should be interpreted with caution.
- A numeric value is assigned to each response. These are used to calculate the average (mean) for each question. Values assigned are:
  - Strongly Agree (6)
  - Agree (5)
  - Mildly Agree (4)
  - Mildly Disagree (3)
  - Disagree (2)
  - Strongly Disagree (1)
  - Unable to Judge (not counted)
- **An overall subject mean is calculated on the 10 core questions only** - Any additional questions included in the survey are not counted towards the mean.
- Mean scores can hide extremes in responses, as such, you are encouraged to also utilise response distribution and percentage agreeable metrics.

## About the SEBS Survey

The SEBS survey has been designed as a tool to assist Subject Coordinators to evaluate their subject(s) in order to assess their impact on student learning. These reports should be compared with, and supported by, information obtained from other sources such as student focus groups, self-reflections and peer reviews. Subject Coordinators are asked to document their reflections (including identified actions to maintain and enhance subject quality) in the Subject Reflection Database on their Faculty Quality Assurance (QA) Moodle Site.

See the Evaluation of Learning and Teaching website for further information.

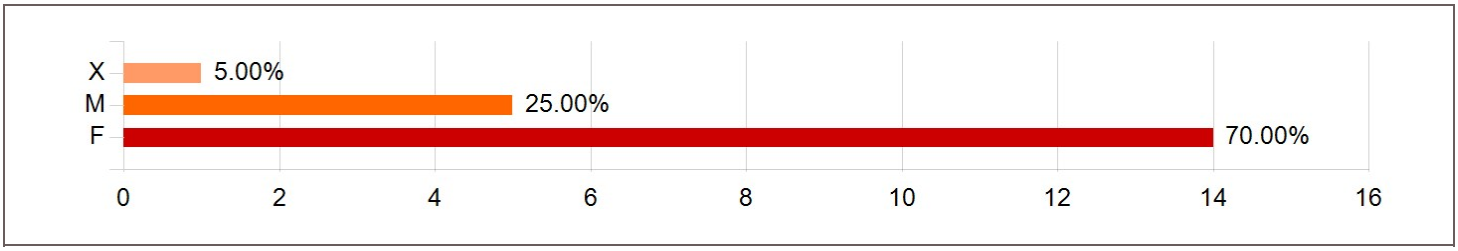
## Closing the feedback loop

Let your students know what changes you make to the subject, in response to your reflections and feedback (including from the SEBS survey) in the next iteration of the Subject Outline.

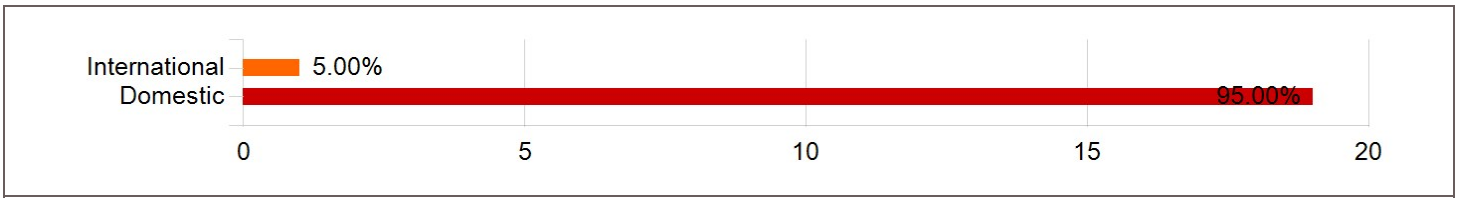
Creation Date: **Wednesday, July 10, 2024**

## About the Respondents

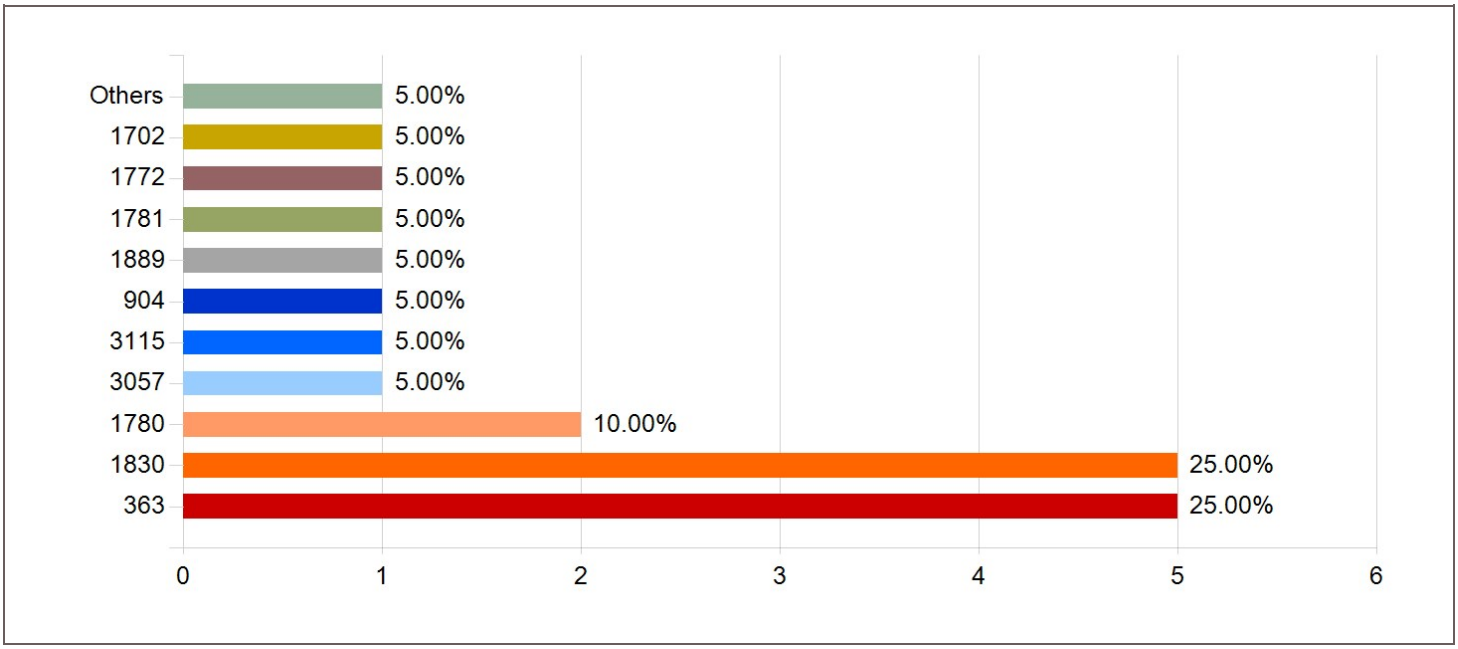
### Gender breakdown




### Domestic/International breakdown




### Course breakdown



## Reliability Assessment Score (RAS)

The RAS gives you an indication of the reliability of the data reflecting accurately the views of the student cohort. Results will be classified as insufficient, sufficient or good. Where scores are considered insufficient we encourage you to review the statistical information with caution and focus instead on the free text comments.

With 20 responses from a survey population of 161, the data presented in this report is considered to be **Sufficient**
Number of responses needed to be considered sufficient: 18
Number of responses needed to be considered good: 53

## Results Summary

Note: The session average score includes all surveys completed across UOW for the current session

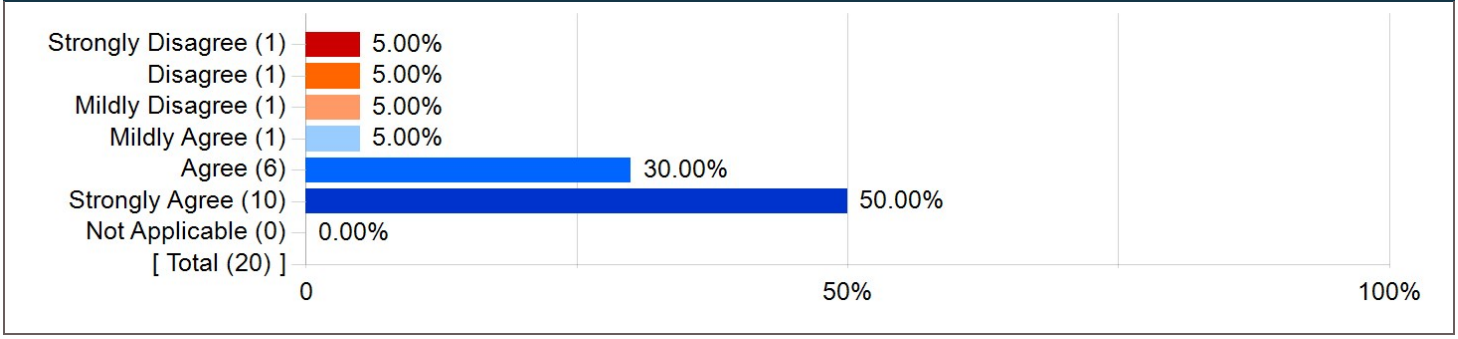
### Subject Evaluation Questions

Note: The response count excludes 'Unable to Judge' responses

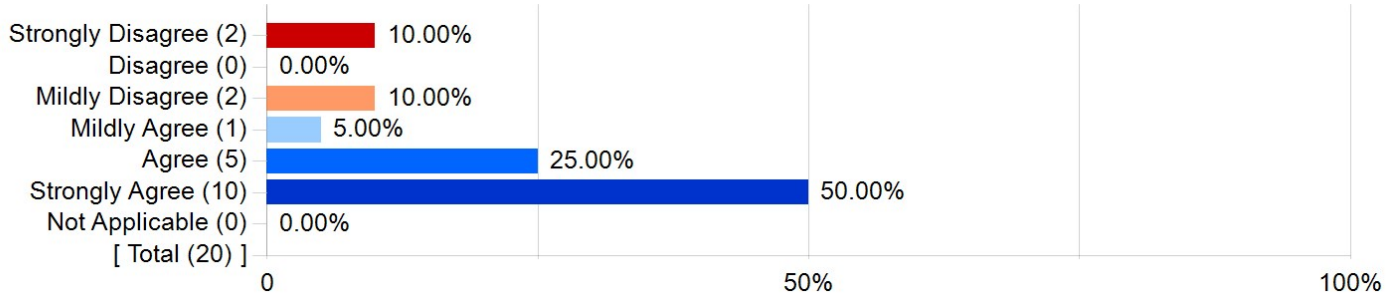
| Question | Subject (BIOL340) | | | | School (School of Chemistry and Molecular Bioscience) | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Response Count | Mean | Min | Max | Response Count | Mean | Min | Max |
| Understood subject requirements and learning outcomes | 20 | 5.00 | 1.00 | 6.00 | 614 | 5.39 | 1.00 | 6.00 |
| Content organised in a clear and logical way | 20 | 4.85 | 1.00 | 6.00 | 613 | 5.31 | 1.00 | 6.00 |
| Subject challenged my thinking | 20 | 5.55 | 1.00 | 6.00 | 611 | 5.54 | 1.00 | 6.00 |
| Learning materials aided my learning | 20 | 5.05 | 1.00 | 6.00 | 611 | 5.30 | 1.00 | 6.00 |
| Technology aided my learning | 20 | 4.80 | 1.00 | 6.00 | 612 | 5.25 | 1.00 | 6.00 |
| Subject provided real world examples connecting theory and practice | 20 | 4.80 | 1.00 | 6.00 | 611 | 5.10 | 1.00 | 6.00 |
| Assessment tasks clearly stated | 20 | 4.75 | 1.00 | 6.00 | 614 | 5.29 | 1.00 | 6.00 |
| Clear connections between assessment tasks and subject learning outcomes | 20 | 4.75 | 1.00 | 6.00 | 613 | 5.34 | 1.00 | 6.00 |
| Timely feedback helped my learning | 20 | 4.45 | 1.00 | 6.00 | 606 | 5.03 | 1.00 | 6.00 |
| Overall satisfaction | 20 | 4.55 | 1.00 | 6.00 | 612 | 5.21 | 1.00 | 6.00 |
| Overall Mean | - | 4.86 | - | - | - | 5.28 | - | - |

## Response Analysis - Core Questions

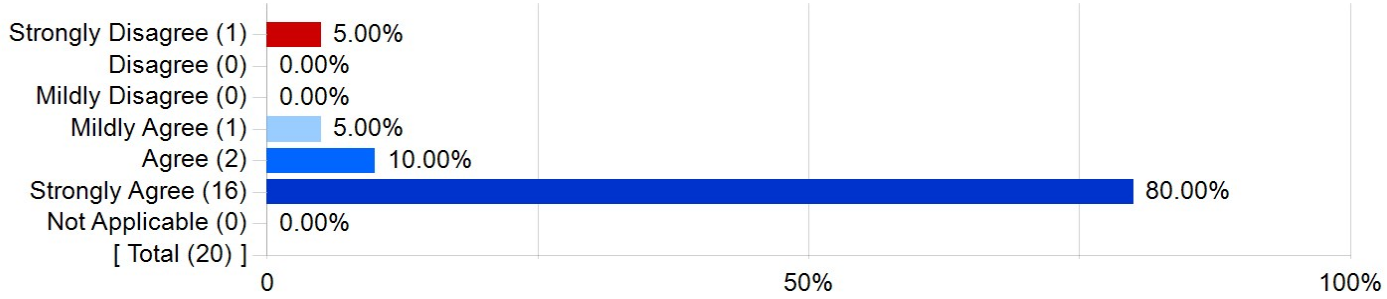
1. Understood subject requirements and learning outcomes



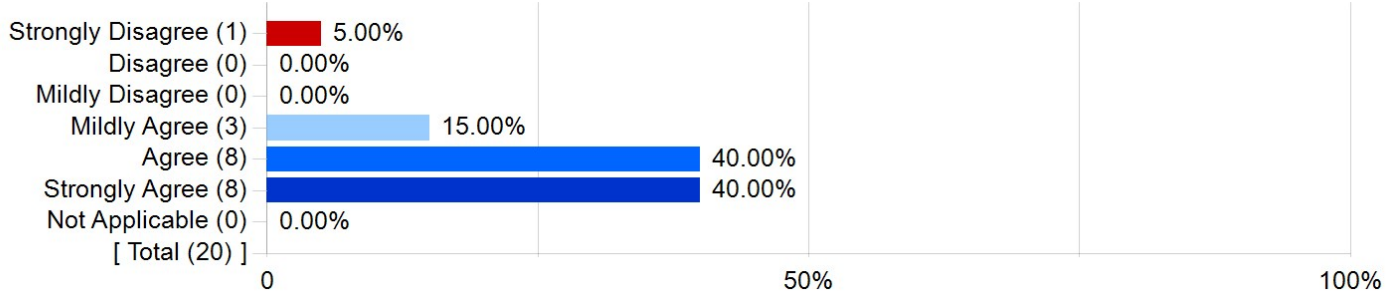
## 2. Content organised in a clear and logical way



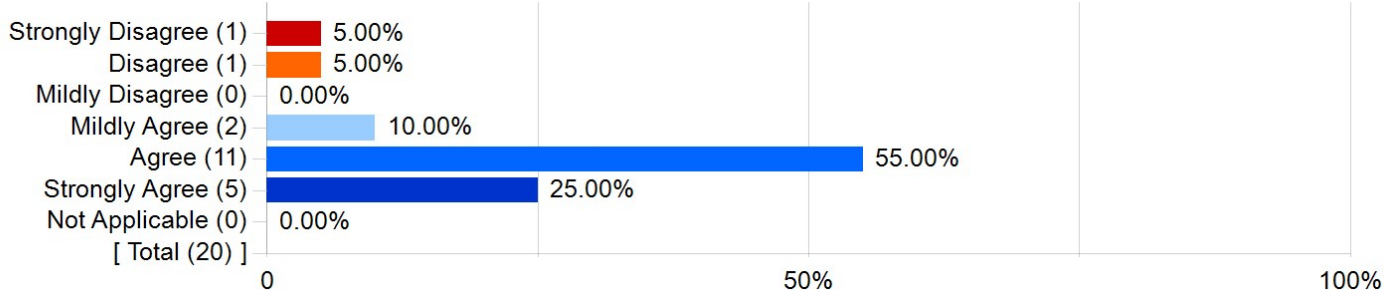

## 3. Subject challenged my thinking



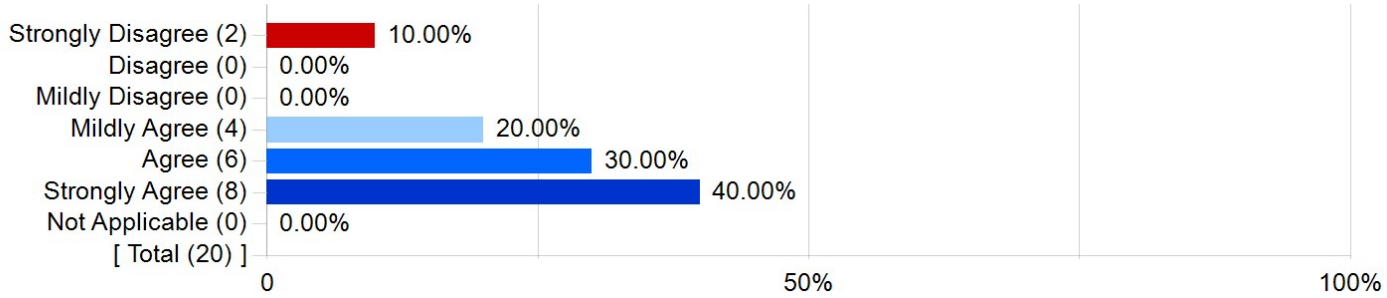

## 4. Learning materials aided my learning



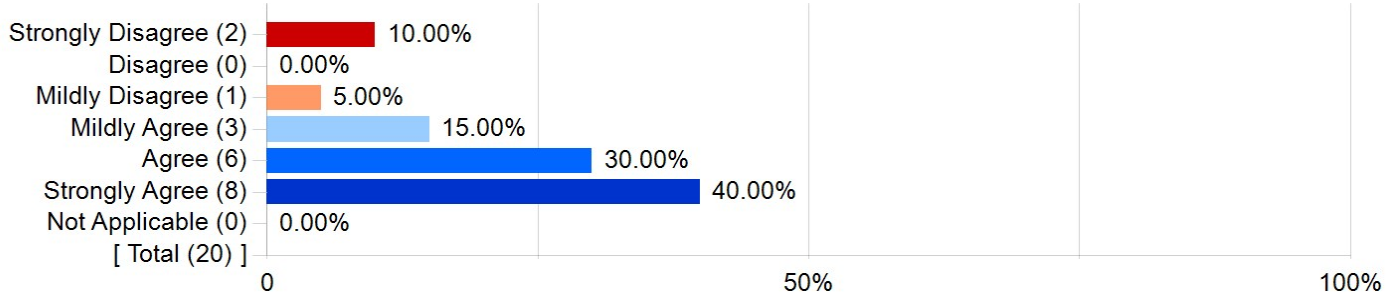

## 5. Technology aided my learning



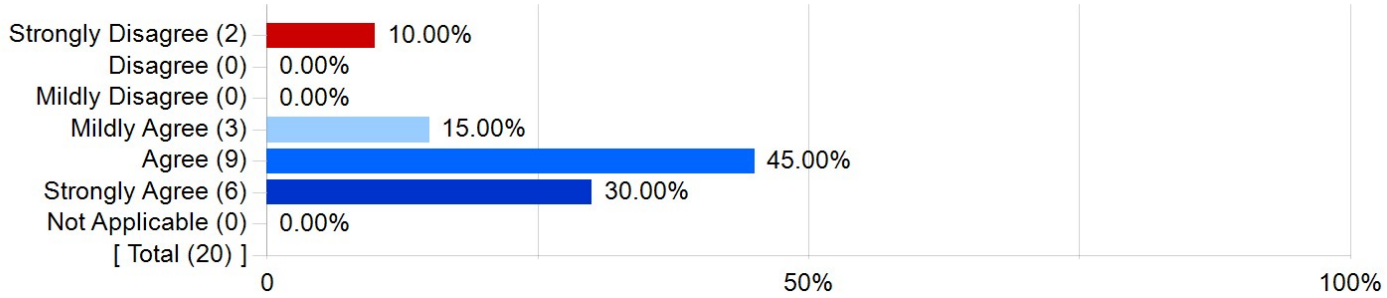
## 6. Subject provided real world examples connecting theory and practice



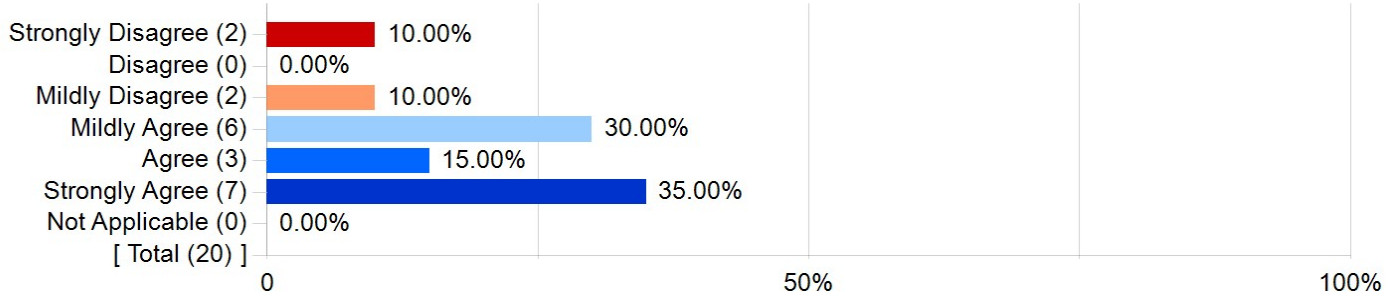

## 7. Assessment tasks clearly stated



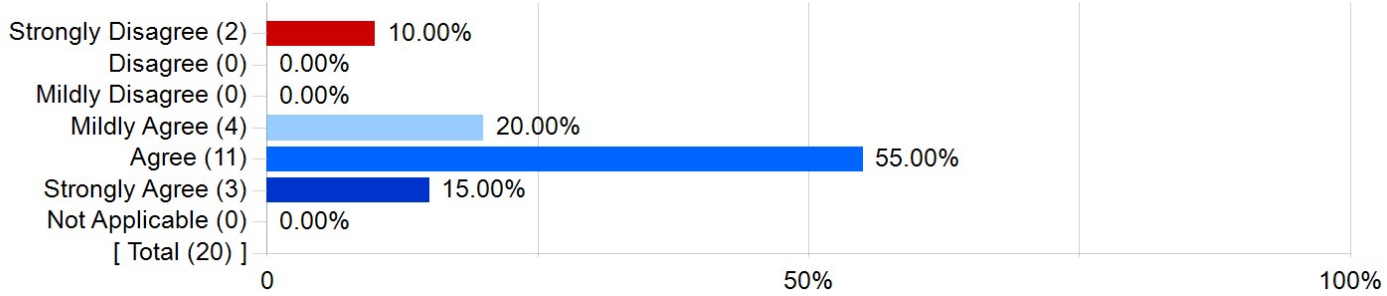
8. Clear connections between assessment tasks and subject learning outcomes




9. Timely feedback helped my learning

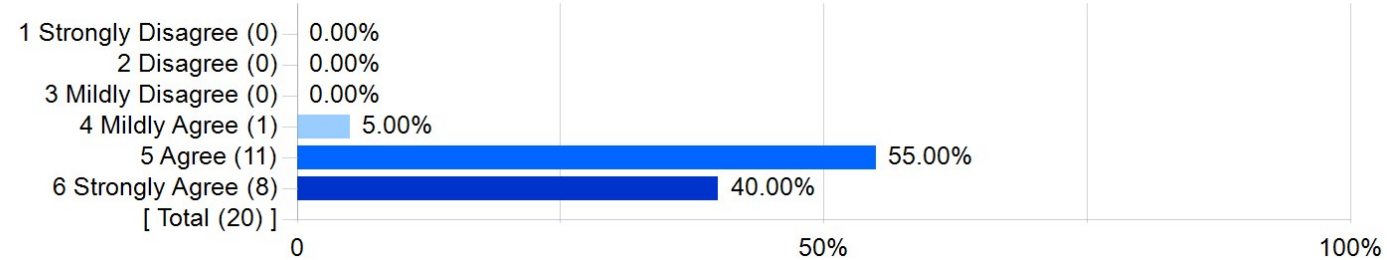



10. Overall satisfaction

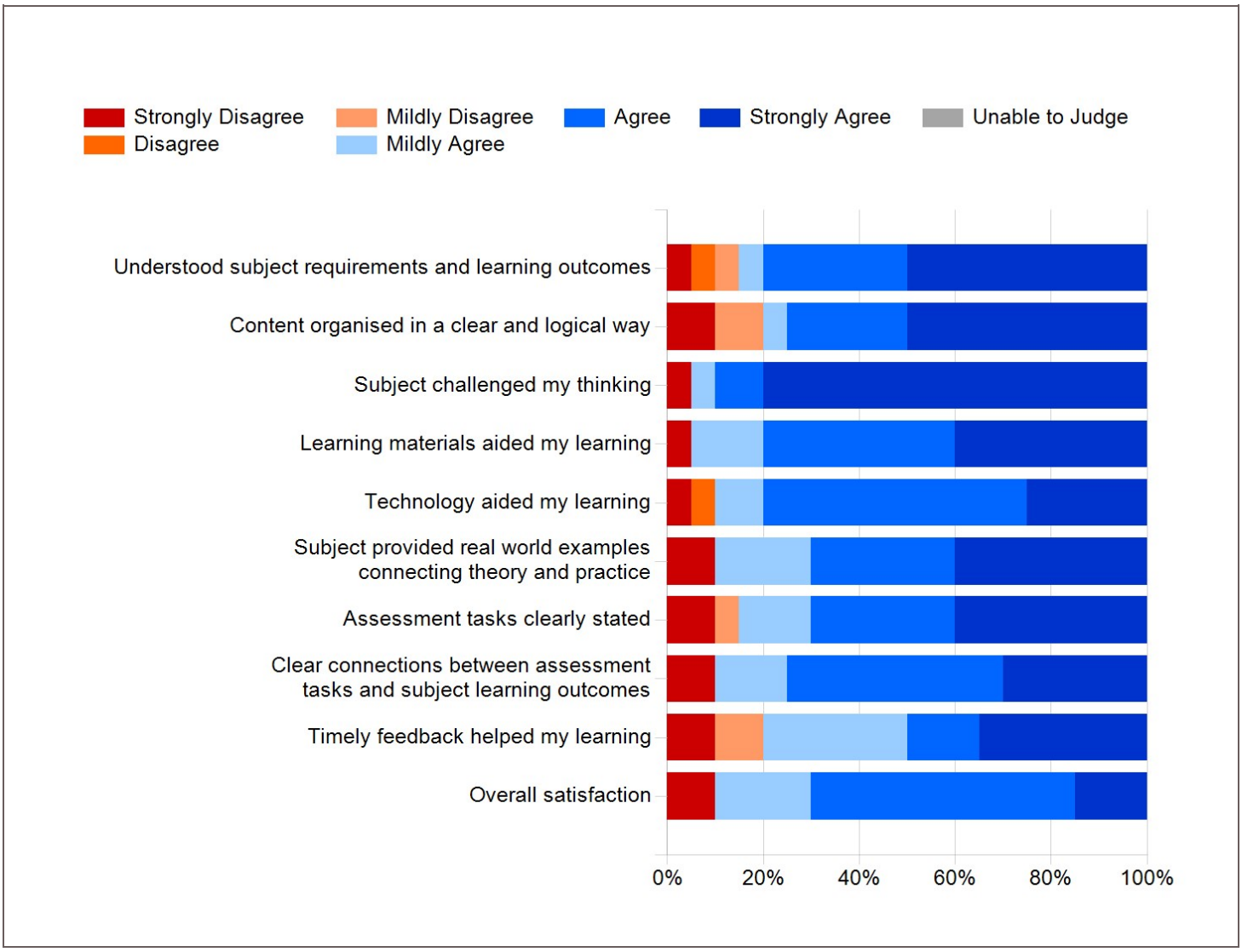



## Strategic Initiative Questions

13. The Moodle site for this subject had a clear layout and was easy to navigate.




## Response Distribution


Strongly Disagree
Disagree
Mildly Disagree
Mildly Agree
Agree
Strongly Agree
Unable to Judge
Understood subject requirements and learning outcomes
Content organised in a clear and logical way
Subject challenged my thinking
Learning materials aided my learning
Technology aided my learning
Subject provided real world examples connecting theory and practice
Assessment tasks clearly stated
Clear connections between assessment tasks and subject learning outcomes
Timely feedback helped my learning
Overall satisfaction
0%
20%
40%
60%
80%
100%

## Breakdown of Responses by Campus

The table below shows the means for each campus across each of the core questions. Campuses only appear in the results when there were six (6) or more responses for that campus.

### Subject Evaluation Questions

| Campus | Q1 | Q2 | Q3 | Q4 | Q5 | Q6 | Q7 | Q8 | Q9 | Q10 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Overall | 5.00 | 4.85 | 5.55 | 5.05 | 4.80 | 4.80 | 4.75 | 4.75 | 4.45 | 4.55 |
| Wollongong | 5.00 | 4.85 | 5.55 | 5.05 | 4.80 | 4.80 | 4.75 | 4.75 | 4.45 | 4.55 |

## Response Analysis - % Agreeable

The table below shows the percentage of students who selected the option: Mildly Agree, Agree, Strongly Agree

| Question | % Agreeable |
|---|---|
| Understood subject requirements and learning outcomes | 85.00% |
| Content organised in a clear and logical way | 80.00% |
| Subject challenged my thinking | 95.00% |
| Learning materials aided my learning | 95.00% |
| Technology aided my learning | 90.00% |
| Subject provided real world examples connecting theory and practice | 90.00% |
| Assessment tasks clearly stated | 85.00% |
| Clear connections between assessment tasks and subject learning outcomes | 90.00% |
| Timely feedback helped my learning | 80.00% |
| Overall satisfaction | 90.00% |

## Response Analysis for School - % Agreeable

The table below shows the percentage of students who selected the option: Mildly Agree, Agree, Strongly Agree

| Question | % Agreeable |
|---|---|
| Understood subject requirements and learning outcomes | 97.23% |
| Content organised in a clear and logical way | 93.96% |
| Subject challenged my thinking | 97.87% |
| Learning materials aided my learning | 96.40% |
| Technology aided my learning | 94.77% |
| Subject provided real world examples connecting theory and practice | 93.78% |
| Assessment tasks clearly stated | 95.28% |
| Clear connections between assessment tasks and subject learning outcomes | 96.90% |
| Timely feedback helped my learning | 90.76% |
| Overall satisfaction | 94.28% |

## Qualitative comments

## 11. What were the best aspects of this subject?

| Comments |
| --- |
| Anuk was an incredible lecturer and the question by question breakdown of the first exam was super helpful. The content was super interesting to me. The modular set out of the subject helped to make it manageable and the pracs worked well with the lecture content |
| The way the tests were broken up into three meaning content could be studied and learned more deeply. |
| The Prelab – Lab – Postlab skills assessment and learning structure is very good at reinforcing learning. The labs are fun, their only fault being the length it takes to incubate samples with nothing to do in the meanwhile. |
| No final exam is amazing :) The 3 theory quizzes throughout were a great alternative |
| Amazing team of teaching staff, from subject coordinators to lecturers to lab demonstrators!<br><br>Our first lecturer Anuk was outstanding with the delivery of the contents. It was laid out in a logical manner with clear example and great slides with funny memes just to enforce our learning but making the lectures light and approachable. His detailed feedbacks for quiz1 was the best I have ever seen and wish more lecturers take in the same amount of time and effort to give the detailed feedbacks like he did.<br><br>Jody and Debbie are the absolute classic duo, no doubt about that!Both lecturers were great at their topics. I love that the cancer lectures were delivered last because it is lighter giving us more time to digest the first four lectures from Jody. (was still hard tho)<br><br>Profeesor Lezanne Ooi lectures were also soo amazing! I have never had her before and while unable to attend her lectures in person, I wish I did! Her delivery is exceptional with her weirdly warm wise, soothing British voice. Her research on the slides made me curious and I looked into her work and what an inspiring woman in science! I am so grateful to have her as my lecturer. I made a fool of myself on quiz3 with her (never meet your hero) but she was so kind and caring.<br><br>While having minimal contact with Dr. Johnston every encounter I had with him either through email or in person, he has always been so kind and understand. We can really see his effort he put in this subject so thank you! Please keep up the amazing work you do.<br><br>Another big shout out is to my lab demonstrator Tom. He takes his time to explain whatever we needed more explanation on, getting us more materials (we seems to run out every prac)Thank you Tom for putting up with our little group! |
| Feedback for exam 1<br>Modular exams<br>Labs |
| I enjoyed the modular assessments worth 15 or 25% each. This made the final test less stressful and by doing them periodically it ensured that you wouldn't get behind too much. The layout of Moodle into lectures and practicals was good as it felt more organised and concise than week by week tabs. The teaching schedule and assessment information documents helped me quickly understand what was happening when and helped me stay organised. I thought it was very helpful not running lectures on the weeks we had quizzes on as it meant we could focus on the quiz instead of falling behind. The theory 1 quiz feedback was very valuable and interesting. The tutors were helpful when they were available. The 3 hours for the post–practical quizzes was very helpful as it tested knowledge not speed. |
| the labs were fun and engaging |
| Modular quizzes helped me stay (or tried to stay) on top of my lecture content and be more involved in the content |
| The modular assessments were a better way to assess the content. Breaking it up into three blocks was easier and it lessened the stress on us students when it came to assessment time. |
| The content was interesting and I liked the range of topics covered. The lecturers were all engaging and knowledgeable. I liked having the lectures in–person, even though the 2 hours straight of lecture is not ideal. It's great (and essential) that the lecturers took a 5–10 minute break in between the lectures in that 2 hour timeslot. The labs were ok, and the lab staff and demos were helpful. |
| The offline theory lectures. |
| The best aspects of this subject would be the lecture slides. |
| the labs were alright |
| The cancer and stem cell weeks where the most interesting, however the post lab quizzes were some of the most poorly formatted and honestly comparable to psychological warfare. The in person quizzes were also terrible. No multiple choice; who does that. |
| Division of lecture content into assessable blocks and the modular layout of exams definitely improved enjoyability of the subject. It was easier to digest theory content and tie it into the associated practicals. Dividing content into 3–4 week blocks ensured you were kept on top of your work, rather than cramming 13 weeks of lectures before a final exam, as many people would tend to do. |

## 12. What changes would you suggest for this subject?

| Comments |
| --- |
| Some of the postlab quizzes had multiple choice questions worth 8 marks or more making up 20% of the grade for that task. Although these were the main takeaways for the prac it would be great to have calculations broken into steps so that partial marks were possible if a student understood most of the content but made a silly mistake or other error |
| The practicals had periods of waiting for too long. |
| The final exam should be moved to the exam period. Nearly every subject has moved to modular examination structure, with the final exams in week 13. This creates a week of abject misery for students, and negates the point in having an exam period. It additionally creates an exam week during which time classes are still on, and there is no StuVac to buffer. Modular exams are nice, though I tend to take them less seriously than larger exams, and study less as a result. Having the final exam weight higher than the other two, and placing it in the exam period could help. |
| the 4 hour labs are KILLERS but i understand that it is sometimes necessary for that time slot |
| more materials in our cooler in the lab thank youuuuu (we're not smart, we prob will muck up sorry) |
| Online practice quizzes would've been nice for exam preparations |
| Even after studying all of the available material and additional material for hours the post practical quizzes were often very hard (particularly post–prac quiz 3). It was frustrating because I knew what to do but often it was the case that the question was very ambiguous and hard to decipher what it was that you actually wanted us to answer. I particularly remember a question where it was very unclear if the first tube had a 1:2 dilution or was not diluted which could throw off the whole calculation. Additionally, I remember with some of the cell counting questions the answers that I came to didn't exactly match the answers that were given, which I did expect them to be off a little bit due to error but it was often the case they were in the middle of two answers. The questions being multiple choice also makes it harder because you cannot put in your working out and get marks for doing the correct working out. It would also be helpful if the questions stated how many answers they were looking for in the questions were it states there may be more than one correct answer, because then it reduces the risk of losing marks for incorrect answers. Additionally, the lack of feedback for the whole subject was disappointing because it ultimately doesn't help us get better because we don't know what we got wrong. Many times if we had access to the post–prac questions it would aid in answering questions in the following post–prac quizzes but because we don't have access to that we didn't know if we were doing it right or wrong. Additionally, tutors also seemed to favour some groups over others which meant that we were often stuck and having to wait for the tutor to assist us. |
| make it more clear in linking the prac to the post lab, first lab was disappointing |
| instead of 3 exams, may an assignment as it was tough |
| I feel like the quizzes should be scheduled when both prac A & B classes aren't running as I feel there was an unfair advantage to Prac B as the Prac A group always had a practical before the quiz. |
| I think the labs could use some fine tuning. Sometimes the practical manuals were written in a way that was hard to understand and follow the methods. |
| – the lecture slides could be much more structured and organised. A great example of this is Anuk's slides. They were in a clear order, following the learning objectives. Jody and Lezanne's slides were less organised, and this makes it difficult for students when writing notes or revising, because you get 'lost in the sauce'. The purpose or meaning of a particular slide of process that you're looking at becomes unclear if you don't have the structure or context of where it fits in the overall topic of the lecture.<br><br>– the labs – specifically the post–lab quizzes were sometimes too difficult, or more so, just badly formatted. I would much rather be asked a handful of multiple choice questions than a ridiculous amount of true/false questions. Questions like that aren't even testing my understanding, they're just nit–picky.<br><br>– this is a bit of a detail, but consistent formatting for how the quizzes and lecture slides look is helpful for students. Some lecturers slides look different with each lecture they give, for example. And quiz 1 looked very different to quiz 2. More consistent formatting helps us get used to what the quizzes and slides will look like, and personally makes it easier for me to learn and focus |
| More guidance and more frequent exams to avoid huge clumps of information on exam day. |
| Connect the lab to the lecture. Also, have the same lecturers for the entire semester because it made it hard to know what to expect on the theory quizzes. |
| You need to talk to your lab demonstrators about not spending the whole of labs helping one whole group and only acknowledging the other groups in the last 5 minutes of the lab.<br><br>You also need to make post–lab quiz marks private until AFTER everyone has done the labs. There have been a student/students that have been getting 100% in the post–labs and sending the answers around to other students – this is COLLUSION and it is not fair to students who are doing the post lab quizzes legitimately and these students who are cheating should be persecuted as such. You should really follow up on this as the post–labs are assessed and account for a decent proportion of marks and these students are aware of what they are doing. You should probably ensure this does not happen in following years. |

| Comments |
| --- |
| Make the wording nicer and especially for true false questions they are so stupid; because sometimes they may be correct or wrong for a specific technicality which would then throw off the entire thing. |
| N/A |

**Session and Year Details** : Autumn - 2024

**Locations Included** : Wollongong

**Delivery modes**: On Campus